

Neon (Rhythm Guitar) -- John Mayer

From *Room for Squares* (2001). About 104 BPM, est.

The studio track is built on Mayer's percussive, syncopated acoustic part: thumb-slapped bass notes, snappy chord stabs, and melody fragments.

On a Strat, the patch keeps that percussive energy. It's a tight, compressed, glassy clean that makes the thumb slaps and chord pops snap. CTL gives a lead voice.

Instrument: Stratocaster (HSS). Position 4 (neck+middle). Thumb for the bass notes, fingers popping the chords. GP-5 only, Stratocaster (HSS), no pedalboard.

AMP: Dark Twin + CAB: EVM112 IR (User IR 5)

A Twin's fast, clean transient response keeps percussive technique crisp. Bright on restores the acoustic snap. EVM112 is the loaded guitar cab with a flat, hi-fi response. It keeps Nashville clean tones honest and doesn't add V30 honk.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 14.

Keeps the muted percussive hits clean.

PRE -- COMP4 (Keeley C4), always on.

Sustain: 48, Attack: 55, Clip: 40, VOL: 58.

COMP4 with a slow-ish Attack 55 lets the slap transient punch through, then evens the sustain. That's the key to the percussive feel.

DST -- Green OD (TS-808), on CTL.

Gain: 26, Tone: 52, VOL: 66.

A light TS for Mayer-style lead lines.

AMP -- Dark Twin, always on.

Gain: 28, VOL: 62, Bass: 52, Middle: 45, Treble: 55, Bright: on.

Clean and fast. Bass 52 so thumb-slapped low notes have weight.

CAB -- User IR 5 (EVM112), always on.

VOL: 60.

EQ -- Guitar EQ 2, always on.

100Hz: +1, 500Hz: -2, 1kHz: 0, 3kHz: +2, 6kHz: 0, VOL: 50.

+1 at 100Hz keeps thumb-note body, standing in for the acoustic's bass. The 500Hz cut removes box. 3kHz for snap.

MOD -- off.

DLY -- Analog, on CTL.

Mix: 12, Time: 290ms, F.Back: 15, Trail: on.

A subtle tail for the lead.

RVB -- Room, always on.

Mix: 12, Decay: 25, Trail: on.

A small room, close and intimate.

CTL footswitch

On CTL: DST (Green OD), DLY (Analog).

- **CTL off** -- Rhythm. Tight, snappy, compressed clean for the percussive thumb-and-pop part. This is the resting state the patch loads into.
- **CTL on** -- Lead. A light TS plus a short tail for melodic fills and a solo.

Engage CTL for the fills and any solo. Off for the main part.